[The Works] Two questions for a great conversation

1 mensagem

Michael Bungay Stanier <teammbs@mbs.works> 31 de março de 2026 às 07:01
Para: André <andre.banki@gmail.com>

read on **MBS.WORKS** | **March 31, 2026**

TAKE YOUR BEARINGS

Know where you are

Who elevates your standards?

A DISTILLATION

Something essential

I had the pleasure of hanging out IRL with Conspirators in Toronto.

One of the roles I try to inhabit is that of a **good host**.

That's not just bringing people I love together for the book launch party, like I did last week.

That's a nice hang, absolutely, but in different settings I'm striving for something a little *more*.

I want great people to know other great people.

I'm shamelessly putting myself in the "great person" category (if I'm not willing to do it, no one else will!), and I want to be in conversation with people who make me *think* and make me *laugh*.

Some of it — just a small part of it, I think — is that insight you've likely heard that "we are the average of the five people we spend the most time with."

So, spend time with people who elevate your standards and create magic through collaboration.

My words of the year for 2026 are “skipping hand-in-hand,” and I’m really chuffed by that vision of “hand-in-hand.”

Whose hand do I get to clasp in delight?

It doesn’t have to be a formal project. It’s really about the opportunity for a moment of light, a flash of something created between two different people.

I hosted a dinner recently in New York. Me and four others, because five is my favourite number for a deep, single-table conversation. Only two of the people knew each other, otherwise they were strangers to each other.

My two questions were:

> What are you known for?
>
> What are you up to?

“What are you known for?” isn’t so much about your public reputation, even though all of these people had a public reputation.

It’s more about how you’re *known by the people* who you care about and who care about you.

It’s an *invitation* to **speak about your values and elemental parts**, perhaps through your accomplishments. It’s a chance to speak about what’s your best.

“What are you up to?” has the hint of the *conspiratorial* to it.

It’s asking what adventure is beckoning, what’s the edge you’re stepping out to, who’s the person you’re *becoming*.

It’s asking you to skip the “business as usual” update and tell me **what’s whispering to you from the future**.

Five people. Three hours of conversation. Two questions that unlocked some magic.

Who would you invite to the table?

TAKE WHAT'S USEFUL

Find the value

Who is the person you're becoming that you're likely to share with others?

ONE LAST THING

There are a lot of great people inside *The Conspiracy* doing great things …

Christine Barnes is launching a Global Learning Community on Inclusion. Her Worthy Goal is to build a global community of people committed to creating more inclusive work environments, and by the looks of things, she's well on her way.

Joanne Hudspith launched her first book, The Power of the Pause. It's not just a book … it's also a course and workbook to help improve resilience by working on your nervous system.

Lina Lo is in the midst of completing the Organization and Relationship Systems Coaching (ORSC) certification, and as part of it, she is running pay-what-you-can Deep Democracy Dialogues the week of April 20th. The purpose of these conversations is to provide a safe space to experience and embody voices that you may not resonate with so that new awareness and actions can emerge.

Jeff Wetherhold is writing the first draft of his book, 50% of which he accomplished in his first 3 months inside *The Conspiracy*!

Regena Garrepy launched her midlife reclamation women's program, and hosted her first in-person retreat in Orlando, Florida, with the help of the focus she finds through her ongoing membership in *The Conspiracy*.

… and so many more!

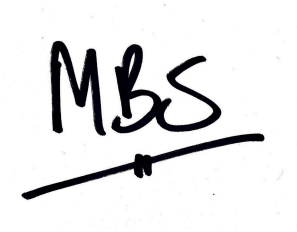
The Conspiracy is our accountability membership program where you unlock your best self while doing your best work, along with a brilliant community of humans doing the same.

Doors open for the next cohort in a few weeks.

Join the waitlist if you want to hang out with curious, ambitious humans who elevate your standards and hold you accountable to them.

You're awesome and you're doing great.

Has this been helpful? Brilliant, I hoped it would. Forward it on to someone else who might enjoy it too.



Unsubscribe | Sent by MBS.works
8 Gladstone Ave Unit 1C, PMD 116, Toronto, Ontario M6J 0B3